

are ready to be installed on your system. Double-clicking the icon takes you to a page that prompts you to 'Express Install' or 'Custom Install' the update. If you select 'Express Install', then the program installs all the updates it has downloaded, and it doesn't reboot your system. If you choose 'Custom Install', you have control over what updates to install. Note that your system would require one or several reboots depending on the updates you selected.

Windows XP Service Pack 1 was released on September 2002; it was a 133 MB download, and contained approximately 19 Critical Updates and around 15 Windows updates. There's a little story about SP1 and the JVM: older copies of XP installed the JVM with Windows. If you updated to SP1, the JVM remained intact. And if you updated to SP1a, the JVM was removed; or, if your copy of XP was manufactured and shipped after SP1a was released, then the JVM was never present on your machine.

Service Pack 2, which was released in August 2004, had significant, crucial security updates as well as updates such as DirectX9 and Windows Media Player 9. Obviously, it doesn't install the JVM on your machine. Refer §9.9.1 for 10 reasons to upgrade to SP2.

10.5 Viruses, Spyware, Adware, And Pop-ups

If you've been reading *Digit*, you'll know how important it is to protect a system from viruses. In Chapter 3 of this book, we've mentioned that you should install anti-virus software even before you connect to the Internet for the first time. Windows XP doesn't have an inbuilt anti-virus, and there are many third-party anti-virus software available. Some anti-virus software are free. Refer section §3.5 for more on these.

Spyware is malicious software designed to intercept or take partial control of a computer's operation without the consent of the machine's owner. The term is used to suggest software that secretly monitors the user, but it has now come to refer more